

ALIGNED WITH THE TIMES

Abbott India has focussed its policies and strategies to achieve its long-term objective of building a diverse and innovative workforce of tomorrow

By **Krishna Gopalan**

AS YOU ENTER the headquarters of Abbott India located in Mumbai's BKC, the mood inside is one of focussed activity interspersed with fun and frolic. A recreation room is filled to the brim with games and bean bags, with employees flitting in and out for a quick moment of rest and relaxation or an intense competition over a board game. And while there is definitely pressure to meet deadlines and be productive at work, the emphasis on taking a break is equally apparent. What we are speaking of is a very large entity positioned as a diversified healthcare business that has been operating in India for over a century now. And its businesses encompass a range of segments from medical devices to diagnostics and nutrition products to branded generic medicines. Powering all this in India are its 12,000-plus employees, the second largest for Abbott's global business after the US.

With its target of remaining a preferred destination for top-notch talent—that it considers is vital for its growth—Abbott India designs policies with employees as the focus. “Talent is a key priority for us and all our initiatives are based on ensuring that we help our employees grow within the organisation. The India talent strategy has been a key strategic pillar to help us deliver our business goals,” says Deepshikha Mukerji, Regional HR Director at Abbott India. With these focus areas, Abbott India has emerged as one of the top companies in the BT-Taggd Best Companies to Work For in India ranking this year.

The long-term objective for the pharma major is to build a diverse, innovative workforce of tomorrow. According to Mukerji, the company's HR policies are aligned with this strategy and business priorities. “Our HR personnel work closely with business leaders to identify key talent priorities, capabilities and succession planning for critical roles. The changes in the external environment and corporate priorities keep re-shaping the talent requirements, impacting both short- and long-term objectives,” says Mukerji.

And to keep up with its talent requirements, Abbott has introduced an employee assistance program (EAP) that offers customised counselling and resource services



10 ABBOTT INDIA TOP ATTRIBUTES

- TALENT IS A KEY PRIORITY
- CARE AND VALUE FOR EMPLOYEES
- SKILL EQUIPMENT PROCESS

◀ **TALENT SPOTTING** Deepshikha Mukerji, Regional HR Director, Abbott India